

Connecticut State Department of Education

DISTRICT PROFILE AND PERFORMANCE REPORT FOR SCHOOL YEAR 2023–24



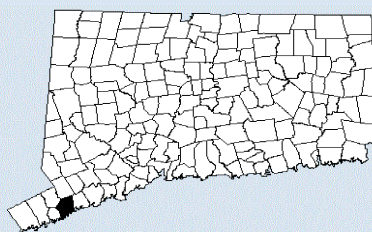
Norwalk School District

Alexandra Estrella, Superintendent • 203-854-4000 • <https://www.norwalkps.org/>

District Information

Grade Range	PK-12
Number of Schools/Programs	26
Enrollment	11,520
Per Pupil Expenditures ¹	\$22,279
Total Expenditures ¹	\$266,858,848

¹ Expenditure data reflect the 2022-23 school year.



Community Information

AdvanceCT Town Profiles provide summary demographic and economic information for Connecticut's municipalities at <https://www.advancect.org/site-selection/town-profiles>

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Notes

Unless otherwise noted, all data are for 2023-24 and include all grades offered by the district.

In most tables, data are displayed only for the three major race/ethnicity categories. For additional race/ethnicity categories, please visit <https://edsight.ct.gov>

State totals are not displayed as they are not comparable to district totals.

Special Education tables reflect only students for whom the district is fiscally responsible.

* When an asterisk is displayed, data have been suppressed to safeguard student confidentiality. Complete data suppression guidelines are available at <https://tinyurl.com/SuppressionPolicy>

N/A is displayed when a category is not applicable for a district or school.

Students

October 1, 2023 Enrollment²

	District		State
	Count	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Female	5,598	48.6	48.3
Male	5,911	51.3	51.5
Non-Binary	11	0.1	0.1
American Indian or Alaska Native	18	0.2	0.2
Asian	425	3.7	5.2
Black or African American	1,544	13.4	12.5
Hispanic or Latino of any race	6,521	56.6	31.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	10	0.1	0.1
Two or More Races	410	3.6	4.7
White	2,592	22.5	46.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	2,484	21.6	10.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	5,905	51.3	44.0
Students with Disabilities ³	1,959	17.0	17.9

² This table represents students in grades PK-12 reported by the district in the Public School Information System (i.e., PSIS Reporting District).

³ Students in this category are students with an individualized education program (IEP) only. This category does not include students with Section 504 plans or services plans.

Chronic Absenteeism and Suspension/Expulsion

	Chronic Absenteeism ⁴		Suspension/Expulsion ⁵	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Female	*	*	*	*
Male	1,137	19.5	462	7.4
Non-Binary	*	*	*	*
Black or African American	355	23.3	195	11.9
Hispanic or Latino of any race	1,459	22.3	421	6.0
White	320	12.6	52	2.0
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	658	24.4	157	5.6
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	1,384	23.8	489	7.4
Students with Disabilities	512	26.0	197	8.4
District	2,258	19.8	703	5.8
State		17.7		7.0

Number of students qualified as truant under state statute: 3,107

Number of school-based arrests: 18

⁴ A student is chronically absent if they miss ten percent or greater of the total number of days enrolled in the school year for any reason. Pre-Kindergarten students are excluded from this calculation.

⁵ This column displays the count and percentage of students who receive at least one in-school suspension, out-of-school suspension or expulsion.

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

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Educators

Full-Time Equivalent (FTE)¹ Staff

	FTE
General Education	
Teachers and Instructors	783.3
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	220.9
Special Education	
Teachers and Instructors	131.0
Paraprofessional Instructional Assistants	129.9
Administrators, Coordinators and Department Chairs	
District Central Office	32.6
School Level	55.5
Library/Media	
Specialists (Certified)	15.0
Support Staff	2.4
Instructional Specialists Who Support Teachers	127.0
Counselors, Social Workers and School Psychologists	94.5
School Nurses	26.0
Other Staff Providing Non-Instructional Services/Support	462.1

¹ In the full-time equivalent count, staff members working part-time in the school are counted as a fraction of full-time. For example, a teacher who works half-time in a school contributes 0.50 to the school's staff count.

Educators by Race/Ethnicity

	Count	District Percent of Total (%)	State Percent of Total (%)
American Indian or Alaska Native	1	0.1	0.1
Asian	32	2.6	1.4
Black or African American	115	9.2	4.8
Hispanic or Latino of any race	150	12.1	5.1
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	0	0.0	0.1
Two or More Races	1	0.1	0.3
White	945	76.0	88.3

Classroom Teacher Attendance: 2022-23

	District	State
Average Number of FTE Days Absent Due to Illness or Personal Time	12.3	13.3

Instruction and Resources

11th and 12th Graders Enrolled in College-and-Career-Readiness Courses during High School²

	11th		12th	
	Count	Rate (%)	Count	Rate (%)
Black or African American	135	97.1	162	99.4
Hispanic or Latino of any race	518	88.5	543	96.3
White	213	98.2	258	98.5
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	159	78.3	141	90.4
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	453	94.0	520	97.9
Students with Disabilities	129	89.0	185	95.9
District	920	92.1	1,032	97.4
State		88.4		94.6

² College-and-Career-Readiness Courses include Advanced Placement®(AP), International Baccalaureate®(IB), Career and Technical Education(CTE), workplace experience and dual credit courses.

Students Who Spend 80% or Greater Time with Nondisabled Peers³

	Count	Rate (%)
Autism	124	51.7
Emotional Disability	49	49.5
Intellectual Disability	*	*
Learning Disability	642	79.7
Other Health Impairment	216	78.5
Other Disabilities	*	*
Speech/Language Impairment	203	91.9
District	1,250	71.5
State		66.8

³ This table represents students ages 6-21 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

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Students with Disabilities by Primary Disability¹

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Autism	264	2.2	2.6
Emotional Disability	100	0.8	1.1
Intellectual Disability	49	0.4	0.6
Learning Disability	806	6.8	6.4
Other Health Impairment	283	2.4	3.5
Other Disabilities	105	0.9	1.2
Speech/Language Impairment	277	2.4	2.0
All Disabilities	1,884	16.0	17.3

¹ This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Students with Disabilities Placed Outside of the District²

	District		State
	Count	Rate (%)	Rate (%)
Public Schools in Other Districts	88	4.7	8.0
Private Schools or Other Settings	68	3.6	4.6

² This table represents students in grades K-12 for whom the district is fiscally responsible (i.e., Nexus District students with an IEP or services plan).

Overall Expenditures³: 2022-23

	Total (\$)	Per Pupil	
		District (\$)	State (\$)
Instruction	\$152,652,038	\$12,744	\$12,942
Support services - students	\$19,063,950	\$1,665	\$1,724
Support services - instruction	\$11,906,341	\$1,040	\$905
Support services - general administration	\$1,022,098	\$89	\$520
Support services - school based administration	\$9,060,838	\$791	\$1,207
Central and other support services	\$5,607,288	\$490	\$771
Operation and maintenance of plant	\$56,909,641	\$4,970	\$2,101
Student transportation services	\$10,636,654	\$1,584	\$1,582
Food services	.	.	\$8
Enterprise operations	.	.	\$213
Total	\$266,858,848	\$22,279	\$21,143

³ Expenditures may be supported by local tax revenues, state grants, federal grants, municipal in-kind services, tuition and other sources.

Special Education Expenditures: 2022-23

	District		State
	Total (\$)	Percent of Total (%)	Percent of Total (%)
Teacher Salaries	\$13,252,183	20.9	27.6
Instructional Aide Salaries	\$8,486,493	13.4	10.2
Other Salaries	\$10,824,162	17.1	10.5
Employee Benefits	\$10,000,460	15.8	13.2
Purchased Services Other Than Transportation	\$4,393,579	6.9	6.4
Special Education Tuition	\$10,914,293	17.2	22.2
Supplies	\$134,511	0.2	0.7
Property Services	\$950	0.0	0.4
Purchased Services For Transportation	\$5,217,384	8.2	8.4
Equipment	\$120,444	0.2	0.3
All Other Expenditures	\$8,932	0.0	0.1
Total	\$63,353,390	100.0	100.0
Percent of Total Expenditures Used for Special Education		23.7	25.0

Expenditures by Revenue Source⁴: 2022-23

	Percent of Total (%) Excluding School Construction
Local	78.7
State	10.8
Federal	9.8
Tuition & Other	0.7

⁴ Revenue sources do not include state-funded Teachers' Retirement Board contributions, Connecticut Technical Education and Career System (CTECS) operations, CSDE-budgeted costs for salaries and leadership activities and other state-funded school districts (e.g., Dept. of Children and Families and Dept. of Correction).

District Profile and Performance Report for School Year 2023-24

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Performance and Accountability

District Performance Index (DPI)

A District Performance Index (DPI) is the average performance of students in a subject area (i.e., ELA, Mathematics or Science) on the state summative assessments. The DPI ranges from 0-100. A DPI is reported for all students tested in a district and for students in each individual student group. Connecticut's ultimate target for a DPI is 75.

	English Language Arts (ELA)		Math		Science	
	Count	DPI	Count	DPI	Count	DPI
American Indian or Alaska Native	*	*	*	*	*	*
Asian	203	73.1	202	72.3	87	69.7
Black or African American	735	54.5	729	48.8	351	47.7
Hispanic or Latino of any race	2,963	54.1	2,955	51.9	1,339	50.8
Native Hawaiian or Other Pacific Islander	*	*	*	*	0	N/A
Two or More Races	193	66.6	190	64.5	*	*
White	1,163	72.9	1,162	70.4	546	67.2
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	1,329	47.6	1,323	47.2	536	44.3
Non-English Learners/Non-Multilingual Learners	3,937	63.6	3,924	60.1	1,849	58.3
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	2,798	54.2	2,782	51.3	1,236	50.1
Not Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	2,468	65.6	2,465	63.0	1,149	60.6
Students with Disabilities	978	42.1	971	37.7	423	38.6
Students without Disabilities	4,288	63.5	4,276	61.2	1,962	58.7
High Needs	3,490	52.9	3,471	50.3	1,538	49.0
Non-High Needs	1,776	72.6	1,776	69.5	847	66.2
District	5,266	59.5	5,247	56.8	2,385	55.1

National Assessment of Educational Progress (NAEP): Percent At or Above Proficient¹

	NAEP 2022		NAEP 2013
	Grade 4	Grade 8	Grade 12
READING			
Connecticut	35	35	50
National Public	32	29	36
MATH			
Connecticut	37	30	32
National Public	35	26	25

¹ NAEP is often called the "Nation's Report Card." It is sponsored by the U.S. Department of Education. This table compares Connecticut's performance to that of national public school students. Performance standards for state assessments and NAEP are set independently. Therefore, one should not expect performance results to be the same across Smarter Balanced and NAEP. Instead, NAEP results are meant to complement other state assessment data. To view performance on NAEP by student group, at https://portal.ct.gov/-/media/SDE/Student-Assessment/NAEP/report-card_NAEP-2022.pdf

Physical Fitness Tests: Students Reaching Health Standard²

	Percent of Students by Grade ³ (%)				All Tested Grades	
	4	6	8	HS	Count	Rate (%)
Sit & Reach	88.5	83.7	82.7	69.5	3,622	79.9
Curl Up	92.7	84.1	87.0	72.3	3,620	82.8
Push Up	83.3	77.3	75.3	59.5	3,605	72.3
Mile Run/PACER	83.0	82.4	71.6	34.0	3,570	64.5
All Tests - District	67.2	57.7	53.2	21.5	3,520	47.3
All Tests - State	53.6	48.4	44.6	42.3		47.2

²The Connecticut Physical Fitness Assessment (CPFA) is administered to students in Grades 4, 6, 8 and High School (HS). The health-related fitness scores gathered through the CPFA should be used to educate and motivate children and their families to increase physical activity and develop lifetime fitness habits.

³Only students assessed in all four areas are included in this calculation.

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Cohort Graduation: Four-Year¹

	2022-23	
	Cohort Count ²	Rate (%)
Black or African American	137	91.2
Hispanic or Latino of any race	464	89.0
White	236	97.0
English Learners/Multilingual Learners	103	70.9
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	580	88.4
Students with Disabilities	139	77.0
District	893	91.6
State		88.4

¹ The four-year cohort graduation rate represents the percentage of first-time 9th graders who earn a standard high school diploma within four years.

² Cohort count includes all students in the cohort as of the end of the 2022-23 school year.

11th and 12th Graders Demonstrating Postsecondary Readiness³

	Count	Rate (%)
Female	375	38.2
Male	325	30.4
Non-Binary	0	*
Black or African American	72	23.8
Hispanic or Latino	282	24.5
White	273	57.0
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	35	9.7
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	258	25.5
Students with Disabilities	19	5.6
District	700	34.0
State		44.3

³Students demonstrate postsecondary readiness through at least one of the following:

- SAT® - meets benchmark score on SAT, Revised SAT or Connecticut School Day SAT
- ACT® - meets benchmark score on 3 of 4 exams (benchmark score varies by subject)
- AP® - 3 or higher on any one AP® exam
- IB® - 4 or higher on any one IB® exam
- Earning three or more non-remedial college credits cumulatively during high school.

Sources:

SAT® and AP® statistics derived from data provided by the College Board.

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ACT® statistics derived from data provided by ACT, Inc.

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IB® statistics derived from data provided by the International Baccalaureate Organization.

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College Entrance and Persistence

	Class of 2023	Class of 2022
	Entrance ⁵ Rate (%)	Persistence ⁶ Rate (%)
Female	74.0	86.2
Male	*	86.9
Non-Binary	*	N/A
Black or African American	66.4	80.6
Hispanic or Latino of any race	60.0	83.8
White	81.9	91.0
English Learners/ Multilingual Learners	31.2	56.5
Eligible for Free or Reduced-Price Meals	61.0	81.7
Students with Disabilities	50.0	67.7
District	67.8	86.5
State	68.4	87.2

⁵ College entrance refers to the percent of high school graduates from the year who enrolled in college any time during the first year after high school.

⁶ College persistence refers to the percent of students who enrolled in college the first year after high school and returned for a second year (Freshman to Sophomore persistence).

Source: National Student Clearinghouse

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Next Generation Accountability Results

Connecticut's Next Generation Accountability System is a broad set of 12 indicators that help tell the story of how well a district/school is preparing its students for success in college, careers, and life. It moves beyond test scores and graduation rates to provide a more holistic, multifactor perspective of district and school performance.

Indicator		Index/Rate	Target	Points Earned	Max Points	% Points Earned	State Average Index/Rate
ELA Performance Index	All Students	59.5	75	39.7	50	79.4	63.9
	High Needs Students	52.9	75	35.3	50	70.5	54.1
Math Performance Index	All Students	56.8	75	37.9	50	75.8	60.2
	High Needs Students	50.3	75	33.6	50	67.1	49.5
Science Performance Index	All Students	55.1	75	36.8	50	73.5	61.8
	High Needs Students	49.0	75	32.7	50	65.4	51.4
ELA Academic Growth	All Students	57.0%	100%	57.0	100	57.0	58.7%
	High Needs Students	54.9%	100%	54.9	100	54.9	54.2%
Math Academic Growth	All Students	60.8%	100%	60.8	100	60.8	61.4%
	High Needs Students	58.0%	100%	58.0	100	58.0	55.1%
Progress Toward English Proficiency	Literacy	57.6%	100%	28.8	50	57.6	58.9%
	Oral	54.2%	100%	27.1	50	54.2	55.2%
Chronic Absenteeism	All Students	19.8%	<=5%	20.4	50	40.8	17.7%
	High Needs Students	24.3%	<=5%	11.5	50	23.0	25.5%
Preparation for CCR	% Taking Courses	94.8%	75%	50.0	50	100.0	91.5%
	% Meeting Benchmark	34.0%	75%	22.7	50	45.3	44.3%
On-track to High School Graduation		87.9%	94%	46.8	50	93.5	84.5%
4-year Graduation All Students (2023 Cohort)		91.6%	94%	97.4	100	97.4	88.4%
6-year Graduation - High Needs Students (2021 Cohort)		88.8%	94%	94.5	100	94.5	86.6%
Postsecondary Entrance (Class of 2023)		67.8%	75%	90.4	100	90.4	68.4%
Physical Fitness (estimated part rate) and (fitness rate)		99.8% 47.3%	75%	31.5	50	63.1	93.6% 47.2%
Arts Access		76.1%	60%	50.0	50	100.0	55.0%
Accountability Index				1017.7	1450	70.2	

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in the student group or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served.

Gap Indicators	Non-High Needs Rate ¹	High Needs Rate	Size of Gap	State Gap Mean +1 Stdev ²	Is Gap an Outlier? ²
Achievement Gap Size Outlier?					Y
ELA Performance Index Gap	72.6	52.9	19.7	16.9	
Math Performance Index Gap	69.5	50.3	19.2	18.2	
Science Performance Index Gap	66.2	49.0	17.2	17.9	
Graduation Rate Gap	94.0%	88.8%	5.2%	9.9%	N

¹If the Non-High Needs Rate exceeds the ultimate target (75 for Performance Index and 94% for graduation rate), the ultimate target is used for gap calculations.

²If the size of the gap exceeds the state mean gap plus one standard deviation, the gap is an outlier.

NOTE: A dot (.) appears in the table above when there are fewer than 20 students in at least one of the student groups used to calculate the gap measure or the indicator is not applicable based on grades served. Gap calculations are based on unrounded rates.

Subject/Student Group		Participation Rate (%) ³
ELA	All Students	97.1
	High Needs Students	96.4
Math	All Students	96.7
	High Needs Students	95.9
Science	All Students	95.4
	High Needs Students	94.1

³Minimum participation standard is 95%.

Connecticut's State Identified Measurable Result (SIMR) for Children with Disabilities

Increase the reading performance of all 3rd grade students with disabilities statewide, as measured by Connecticut's English Language Arts (ELA) Performance Index.

Grade 3 ELA Performance Index for Students with Disabilities:

District: 46.5

State: 49.7

Supporting Resources: <https://public-edsight.ct.gov/Overview/Next-Generation-Accountability-Dashboard#related-links>

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Narratives

In 2023-24, Norwalk Public Schools' EEI Team's specific goals were to: expand Social Emotional Learning program to support Black and Brown students; develop a data-driven culture with access to tools utilized to inform action; provide professional development to enhance staff's knowledge and understanding of how to reduce inequities and foster a more equitable school district; develop a Portrait of a Graduate for Norwalk Public Schools to serve as our guiding principle in alignment with our Strategic Priorities; and ensure that families are provided with equitable opportunities to access district resources and programs.

The district's My Brothers Keeper and My Sisters Keeper programs have expanded in reach, influence and district focus. My Brother's Keeper increased by 20 students from 80 in 2023 to 100 in 2024, and My Sister's Keeper increased by 35 students from 85 in 2023 to 120 in 2024. The programs are run by staff and chaperones who students can identify with and the average satisfaction rate for the programs is 92 percent.

The district has provided professional development opportunities for staff members on implicit bias utilizing support from the Equity Institute and 100 teachers participated in professional development sessions on various equity-focused topics.

The district collected extensive feedback from community surveys and received favorable feedback from families about communication in our Panorama Survey. In the Panorama Survey, students overall demonstrated increases in their response to questions about emotional regulation, rigor of academic expectations, school culture and climate, and staff leadership relationships. While the district aims to raise all subgroups within that strata, the district is pleased with raising the overall positive response.

The district oversaw an increase in the number of Black students in grades 1-8 reaching the National Norm in 2024 Reading and Math NWEA scores compared to 2023. There has also been a decline in the suspension of Black students each of the last three years, as well as a reduction in Chronic Absenteeism rates for Black and Hispanic students for the last three years.

In terms of facilities, one new school building opened and two new school projects broke ground during the 2023-24 school year.

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Equitable Allocation of Resources among District Schools

One of Norwalk Public Schools' Finance Teams main goals for the 2023-24 school year revolved around an assessment of resource allocation to determine equitable distribution of staff resources in schools. The Finance Team was pleased to complete Phase I of this assessment this year.

The Student Based Budgets (SBB) continue incorporating specialized learning and multilingual learners expenses within each school budget allowing for better management and tracking of expenses and services at the school level. School principals have been trained in SBB so that they have the knowledge needed to allocate those resources according to the needs of their schools.

School Governance Councils operate at every school, providing additional opportunities for parents, staff and community members to advise district and school leaders. SGCs met quarterly from each school to report on efficacy of said procedures and the change that may have been needed in addressing these.

Staff members are assigned based on the number of students and programs operating in that individual school, in accordance with contractual class size limits. The Budget Book has also been redesigned for better transparency.